

RACI Definitions + Matrix Template

Day 1 · Activity 3 handout. Assign each stakeholder a role for the five most consequential decisions on your feature. The discipline: exactly one **A** per decision.

The four letters

LETTER	ROLE	DEFINITION
R	Responsible	Does the work. There can be many R's.
A	Accountable	Owens the outcome. Exactly one person per decision.
C	Consulted	Two-way conversation; opinion sought before the call.
I	Informed	One-way notification; outcome shared after the call.

The core discipline: one A per decision. If two people are A, neither is. If no one is A, the decision will rot.

The five decisions to assign

For most features, RACI these five:

1. **Scope** — what's in vs out
2. **Architecture** — TCD §1 stance + key trade-offs
3. **SLO targets** — TCD §4
4. **Launch date** — when it ships
5. **Out-of-scope follow-up backlog** — deferred items + owners

Matrix template

Fill one row per decision. Multiple R / C / I are fine; **one A only**.

Decision	R	A	C	I
Scope				
Architecture				
SLO targets				
Launch date				
OOS backlog ownership				

Worked example — FieldPulse "End-of-Day Reconcile"

Decision	I	R	A	C
Scope	Success	TPM (you)	PM Director	Eng Lead, Architect, Customer
Architecture	All eng	Architect	Eng Director	TPM, Security, Platform
SLO targets	Eng Director	Eng Lead	TPM	SREs, Customer Success
Launch date	Marketing	TPM	PM Director	Eng Lead, Customer Success,
00S backlog ownership	Backlog readers	TPM	TPM	Eng Lead

Four checks before you're done

1. **No two A's** — walk every column; verify exactly one A per decision.
2. **Is the A actually empowered?** — for each A, confirm they have the authority (formal + informal) to make the call. Many nominal A's are rubber stamps; the real A is upstream.
3. **Anyone surprised to be an I?** — a stakeholder often gets I when they think they're C. Surface it and decide.
4. **"We're all R" is a smell** — it usually means responsibility is unclear. Push for specificity.

Common error: the TPM writing "I'll be A" on architecture. TPMs are usually **C** on architecture, with the Architect as **R** and the Eng Director as **A**.